

Custom Table Block

To be reviewed with TFS as redesigned the authoring way.

Summary

The custom-table-block(`data-list`) block replaces the old AEM Table + Row approach with a single spreadsheet-driven pattern. Authors maintain a single spreadsheet (one source of truth). The block reads that spreadsheet's JSON and automatically builds search, filters, pagination and the item cards — same look-and-feel, much simpler authoring.

Key concept

Author fills rows in a spreadsheet (columns = fields). `data-list` fetches a JSON endpoint derived from that spreadsheet and:

- auto-extracts filter values from specified columns
- builds the search bar and filter dropdowns
- renders item cards (title, date, image, description, link)

Authors only edit the spreadsheet and block config.

Example spreadsheet (columns)

title	date	end-date	location	description	link	image	event-type	country	month	search-keywords
SLAS 2026	2026-02-07	2026-02-11	Boston, MA US	Short event blurb	/events/latest-2026	/images/slasp.jpg	Tradeshow	United States	February	SLAS, Automation

Column roles

- Display: `title, date, description, image, link`

- Filters: `event-type, country, month` (these columns become the filter dropdowns)
 - Search: `search-keywords` (hidden, used for text search)
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Block configuration (what the author sets in the editor)

The `data-list` block exposes the familiar options authors expect:

- **Data Source** (text) — path to spreadsheet JSON endpoint (e.g. `/events-data`)
 - **Searchable** (boolean) — enable text search bar
 - **Filterable** (boolean) — enable filter dropdowns
 - **Filter Columns** (text) — comma-separated column names to use as facets (e.g. `event-type, country, month`)
 - **Enable Pagination** (boolean) — show pagination controls
 - **Default per page** (select) — 5 / 10 / 15 / 20 / 25
 - **Left Navigation for Filters** (boolean) — place filters in left rail vs top bar
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Authoring workflows

Add a new item (example: event)

1. Open spreadsheet (e.g., `events.xlsx`).
2. Add a new row and fill fields (title, date, location, image, event-type, etc.).
3. Save the spreadsheet.
4. Page renders the new item automatically — no page-edit in AEM required.

Remove an expired item

- Delete the row from the spreadsheet and save. Filters update automatically if that removed row was the last instance of a value.

Bulk update

- Edit many cells in the spreadsheet (e.g., change 20 dates), save once.
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Comparison: AEM Table (today) vs EDS `data-list` (proposed)

Concern	AEM Table + Rows	EDS <code>data-list</code>
Where data lives	Table config + many Row child components	One spreadsheet (single source)

Defining filters	Manual list in Table config + per-row mapping	Derived from spreadsheet columns
Add new item	Add Row in AEM, map filters, publish	Add row in spreadsheet, save
Bulk edits	Edit each Row individually	Edit spreadsheet cells, save once

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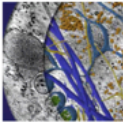


Event Type - Country - Month -

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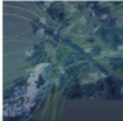
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